

MRK - Research Report

Merck & Co., Inc. · Healthcare / Drug Manufacturers - General
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INTERNAL

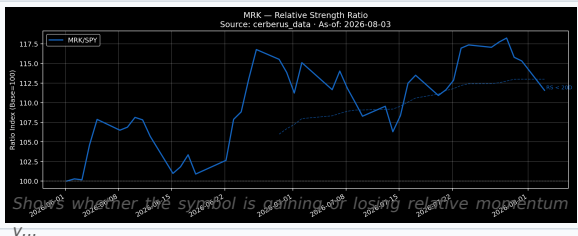
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SCORE 54.66/100	VERDICT Monitor for reclaim	PRICE 127.77
SETUP Breakout @ 135.05	TARGET GAP target gap +5.96%	R/R 2.0:1
NEXT EARNINGS 2026-08-04		
Catalysts Earnings on 2026-08-04 Dividend recorded 2026-06-15		
Risks Merck Stock Rises as Wall Street Looks Past Earnings Guidance Cut to Oncology Strength		
Setup Setup: Breakout Trigger: Level / Status Invalid: 121.00 / EMA21 127.50 Target: 141.31		

Executive Summary

- Score: 54.66/100
- MONITOR
- State: Hold / Neutral
- State: Uptrend / Range

Relative Strength Ratio



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Generated from Cerberus research markdown export.

Executive Summary & Verdict

****NEUTRAL HOLD / NEUTRAL****

NOTE

Technical Score: 54.66/100 · Verdict: MONITOR · Advice: Hold / Neutral

Pillar	Assessment
Market Cycle	Stage 2 — Uptrend OK
Trend / Regime	Uptrend / Range
TTM Squeeze	—
Valuation (P/E)	36.95x — elevated
Return on Equity	18.94% OK
Net Margin	13.59% OK
Debt/Equity	106.94 OK
Analyst Mean Target	\$135.38 — +5.96% from current

Data Quality

PROVIDER QUALITY SCORE 90.00/100	EFFECTIVE REPORT CONFIDENCE 45.00/100
FRESHNESS STATUS STALE DATA	

Data Freshness Brief

STATUS STALE	FRESH / STALE / UNKNOWN 0 / 25 / 1
TRACKED DATASETS 26	DETAIL LOCATION Appendix / Data Freshness & Provenance

Investment Case

THESIS Hold / Neutral (MONITOR setup)	VERDICT MONITOR
TIME HORIZON Swing	ENTRY / TRIGGER 135.05
STOP / INVALIDATION 121.00 (-5.30%)	TRADE TARGET 141.31 (10.60%)
ANALYST MEAN TARGET 135.38 (5.96%)	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1

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NEXT CATALYST
2026-08-04

POSITIONING
major \$9.77M / retail \$-117.37M

Investment Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	favorable asymmetry
Implication	setup supports action if trigger clears
Watch Next	trigger 135.05 and catalyst 2026-08-04
Confidence	high

Decision Dashboard

Lens	Read	Lens	Read
Trend	100.00	Momentum	44.24
Risk Adjusted	78.57	Confidence	9.31
Valuation	Rich	Flows	Accumulation
Macro Regime	neutral	Event Window	Today
Relative Context	11.60% vs benchmark	Setup	Uptrend / Range

Dashboard Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	signal stack weak
Implication	position sizing should stay selective
Watch Next	flows accumulation and event window today
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

Report Summary

Lens	Summary
Thesis	Hold / Neutral
Score / Verdict	54.66 / MONITOR
Strongest Evidence	Trend 100.00
Biggest Drag	Drawdown 0.00
Catalyst	2026-08-04
Invalidation	121.00
Flow Backdrop	\$9.77M

Summary Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	summary supports current call
Implication	thesis still needs cleaner confirmation
Watch Next	watch catalyst 2026-08-04 and flow follow-through
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Thesis Delta Brief

Lens	Read
Status	Unavailable
Reason	No previous same-profile report artifact found for delta comparison.

Signal Conflicts

Conflict	Why It Matters
trend strong but momentum weak	setup needs extra confirmation before conviction should rise

Conflict Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	signals not fully aligned
Implication	contradictions reduce sizing confidence even if the headline score looks fine
Watch Next	watch whether price, relative strength, and flow start confirming each other
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Anomaly Watchlist

Anomaly	Action
short ratio moved materially vs 20D average	treat as exception path until it normalizes or confirms the thesis

Anomaly Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	outlier conditions active
Implication	tail events can dominate normal signal interpretation
Watch Next	watch whether the anomaly fades, persists, or starts moving price
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Conviction Gradecard

Pillar	Weight	Score
Trend	35%	100.00
Momentum	30%	44.24
Risk-Adjusted	20%	78.57
Valuation	15%	30.00
Composite	100%	68.49 (B / Accumulate)

Confidence Decomposition

Driver	Value
Strong: Trend	100.00
Strong: Risk Adjusted	78.57
Strong: Vol Stability	73.51
Weak: VWAP	0.00
Weak: Drawdown	0.00
Weak: Trend Strength	38.89
Read	Support led by Trend, Risk Adjusted, Vol Stability; drag from VWAP, Drawdown, Trend Strength

NOTE

Score Bars: Momentum 44 | Trend 100 | RiskAdj 79 | VolStab 74

Price Snapshot

Snapshot

PRICE \$127.77	MARKET CAP \$318.48B
52W HIGH \$135.05	52W LOW \$77.58
BETA 0.21	DIVIDEND YIELD 2.61%
TRAILING P/E 36.95	FORWARD P/E 13.37
EPS (TTM) 3.49	SHARES OUT 2.47B
FLOAT 2.47B	FLOAT % 99.83%

Returns

1Y	YTD	MTD	WTD	1D
+59.99%	+20.03%	+0.00%	+0.00%	-1.87%

Setup / Risk Dashboard

CURRENT PRICE 127.77	PRIMARY TRIGGER 135.05
STOP 121.00	TRADE TARGET 141.31
STREET HIGH TARGET 155.00	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1
ATR(14) 3.38	EXPECTED MOVE BAND 2.65%

Setup Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	risk map actionable
Implication	trade can be planned before entry
Watch Next	break 135.05 with stop held above 121.00
Confidence	high

Setup Quality Grade

GRADE C	COMPOSITE SETUP SCORE 53.98
SIGNAL STACK trend 100.00, momentum 44.24, confidence 9.31	REWARD / RISK 2.00:1
UPSIDE TO TARGET 10.60%	ROOM TO STOP -5.30%

Catalyst Summary Card

NEXT EARNINGS 2026-08-04	EARNINGS COUNTDOWN Today
EXPECTED MOVE PROXY 2.65%	LATEST DIVIDEND / SPLIT 2026-06-15
TOP CATALYSTS Earnings on 2026-08-04 ; Dividend recorded 2026-06-15 ; Analyst target gap +5.96%	TOP RISKS Merck Stock Rises as Wall Street Looks Past Earnings Guidance Cut to Oncology Strength

Scenario Analysis

Scenario	Trigger	Path	Consensus Context	Fail Condition	Probability
Bull	break > 135.05	trade target 141.31 (+10.60%)	analyst mean 135.38 (+5.96%)	lose 121.00	22%
Base	hold > 127.77	drift to 131.83 (+3.18%)	analyst mean 135.38 (+5.96%)	fail to reach 141.31	45%
Bear	lose 121.00	path 121.00 (-5.30%)	analyst mean 135.38 (+5.96%)	reclaim 135.05	33%

Key Debate

Side	Framing
Bull Case	trend and momentum support continuation
Bear Case	edge is mostly narrative, not cross-validated
Decision Variable	confidence 9.31, major flow \$9.77M, momentum 44.24

Key Reasons

Side	Detail
Reasons To Be Long	trend score 100
Reasons To Be Long	5D major flow \$9.77M
Reasons Not To Be Long	signal confidence 9%
What Changes The Call	Hold / Neutral breaks if stop fails or catalyst path deteriorates



Figure 1. Price Chart - Candlestick + SMA + Volume + RSI (1Y)

Chart Read: Shows the primary price trend, participation, and momentum backdrop.

Read: setup offers about 10.6% upside versus 5.6% stop distance. Why it matters: combines trend, participation, and execution levels in one view. Source: local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

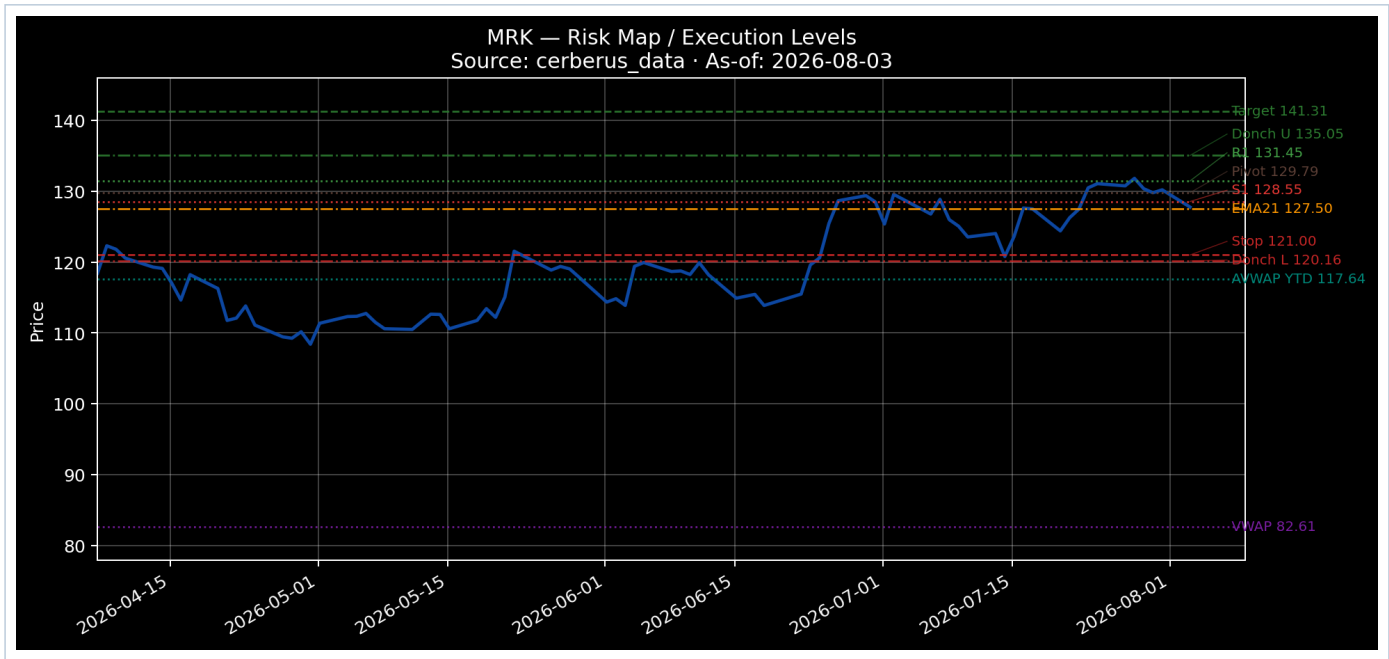


Figure 2. Risk Map and Execution Levels

Chart Read: Maps trigger, stop, and target levels into one execution view.

Read: payoff skew is favorable if trigger quality holds. Why it matters: makes trigger, invalidation, and target explicit. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

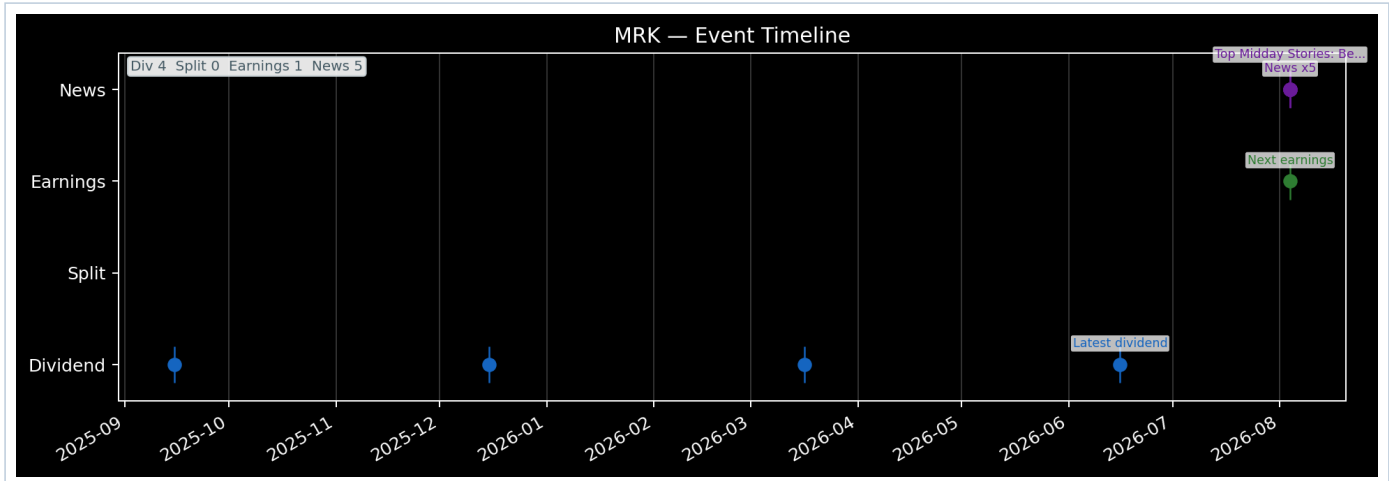


Figure 3. Catalyst and Event Timeline

Chart Read: Shows when key corporate events and headline catalysts occurred or are upcoming.

Read: next event window centers on 2026-08-04. Why it matters: timing of catalysts drives path dependence for the setup. Source: SEC events + earnings + news · As-of: 2026-05-28

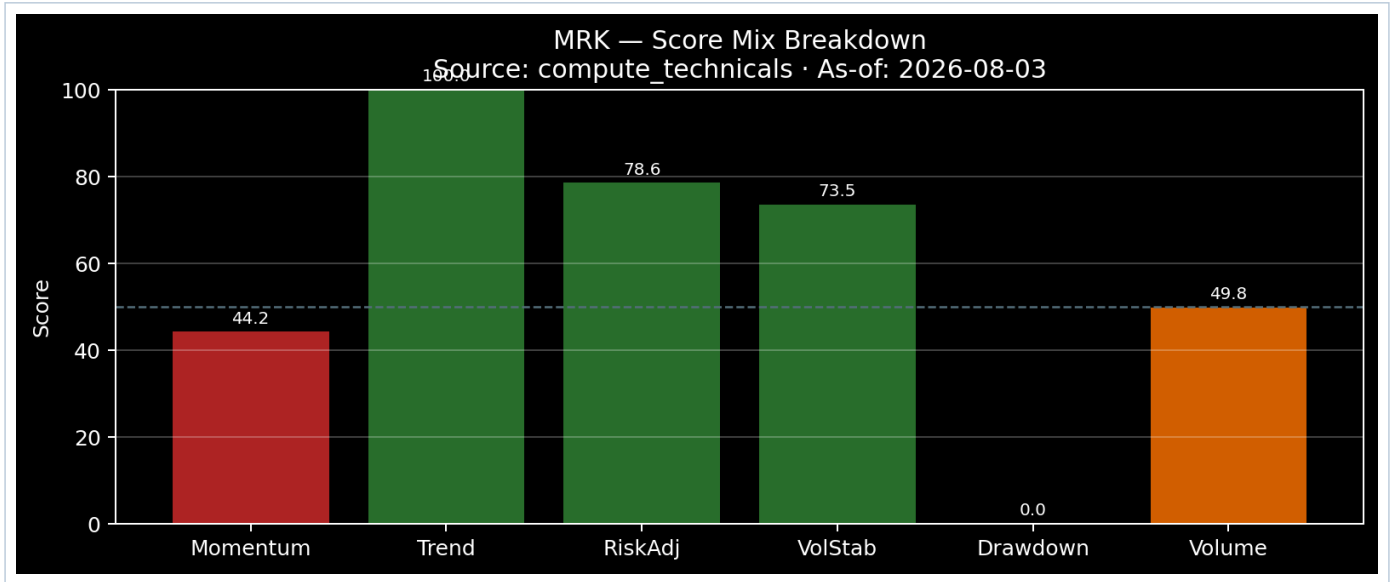


Figure 4. Score Mix Breakdown

Chart Read: Shows which technical sub-scores are carrying conviction and which remain weak.

Why it matters: shows which score drivers are carrying or dragging conviction. Source: technical scoring · As-of: 2026-08-03

Peer / Benchmark Snapshot

PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY	6M RELATIVE VS PRIMARY 11.60%
MEDIAN PEER 6M RELATIVE 15.38%	NET MARGIN VS PEER MEDIAN 13.59% vs -

Relative Strength / Benchmark Context

1Y RETURN (SYMBOL) 59.99	YTD RETURN (SYMBOL) 20.03
BETA VS MARKET 0.21	PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY
BENCHMARK-RELATIVE RETURN (6M) 11.60%	INDEX MEMBERSHIP sp500
EXCHANGE / TYPE NYQ / EQUITY	INTERPRETATION leader

Horizon	Symbol	Benchmark	Spread
1M	-1.38%	1.73%	-3.11%
3M	13.73%	0.14%	13.59%
6M	11.12%	0.14%	10.97%
1Y	65.34%	0.14%	65.20%

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PRIMARY BENCHMARK SPY	6M RELATIVE RETURN VS SPY 11.60%
PEER RANK 5/7	PEER PERCENTILE 33.33%
BREADTH (PEERS POSITIVE 1Y) 5/6	BREADTH (PEERS POSITIVE 6M REL) 6/6
MA PARTICIPATION 3/4 above	INDEX MEMBERSHIP sp500
INTERPRETATION outperforming primary benchmark; above 3/4 key MAs	PEER READ clean
LEADERSHIP Leader	CROWDING Clean
POSTURE Balanced	PRIMARY RELATIVE 11.60%
PEER PERCENTILE 33.33%	CONCLUSION leader; vs primary benchmark positive; clean positioning

Relative Strength Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	relative leadership confirmed
Implication	outperformance supports staying in the name over the benchmark
Watch Next	relative ratio and breadth must stay aligned
Confidence	high

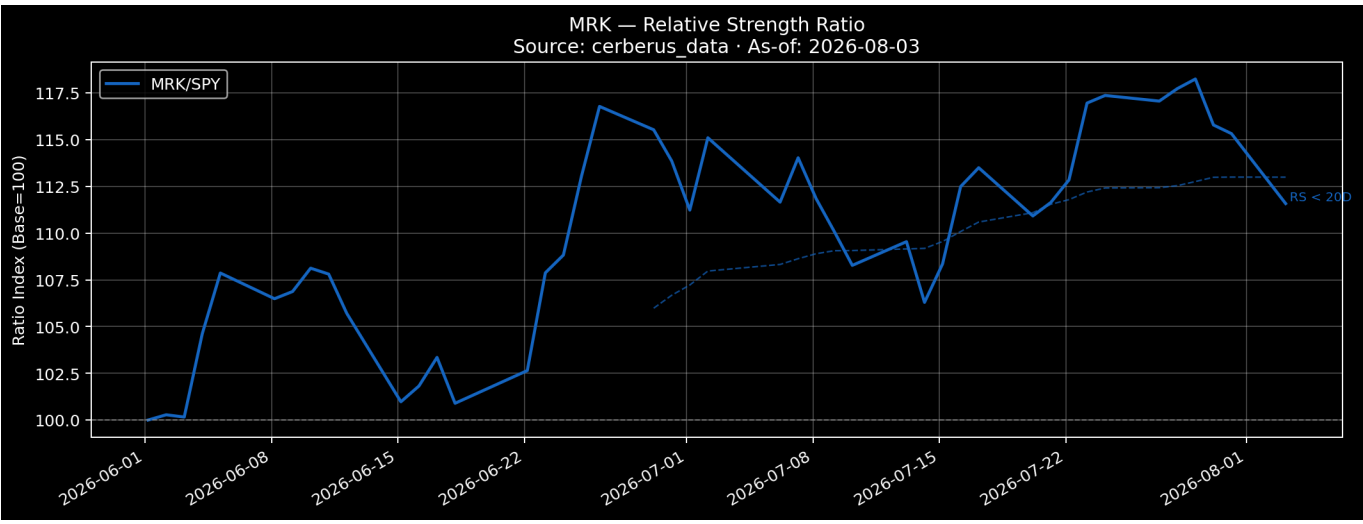


Figure 5. Relative Strength Ratio

Chart Read: Shows whether the symbol is gaining or losing relative momentum versus its benchmark.

Read: beating SPY by 11.6%. Why it matters: confirms whether the symbol is actually outperforming its benchmark set. Source: local market data vs benchmark · As-of: 2026-08-03

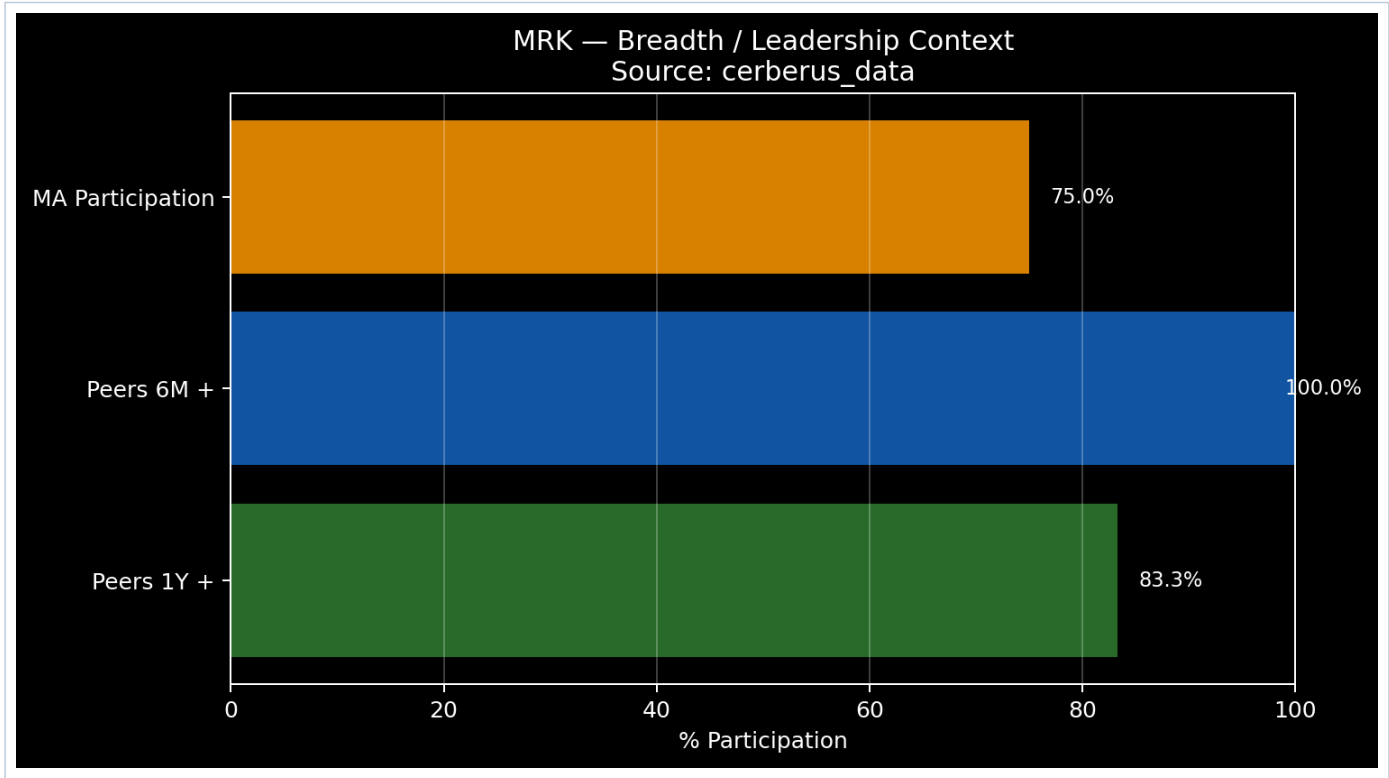


Figure 6. Breadth and Leadership Context

Chart Read: Shows how broadly supported the move is across peers and moving-average participation.

Why it matters: tests whether leadership is broad or narrow versus peers. Source: peer snapshot / local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

Peer Allocation View

NOTE
Peer cut vs SPY using local index/sector mapping.

Lens	Subject	Peer Medi...	Verdict
6M Relative Return	11.60%	15.38%	Inline
1Y Return	59.99%	27.59%	Leader
Net Margin	13.59%	—	Unavailable
Operating Margin	38.60%	—	Unavailable
5D Major Flow	\$9.77M	\$-15.79M	Leader
Panel Verdict	leader	6 peers	SPY

Benchmark-relative context vs SPY using local sector/index peers.

Symbol	1Y Return	6M Rel	Net Mar...	Op Margin	5D Major Flow
BAX	28.99%	52.57%	—	—	\$-10.39M
ABT	-14.51%	22.76%	—	—	\$-41.57M

Symbol	1Y Return	6M Rel	Net Mar...	Op Margin	5D Major Flow
ABBV	28.53%	15.78%	—	—	\$-194.89K
AMGN	30.47%	14.97%	—	—	\$-21.19M
A	23.92%	2.86%	—	—	\$-2.96M
ALGN	26.64%	1.70%	—	—	\$-46.58M

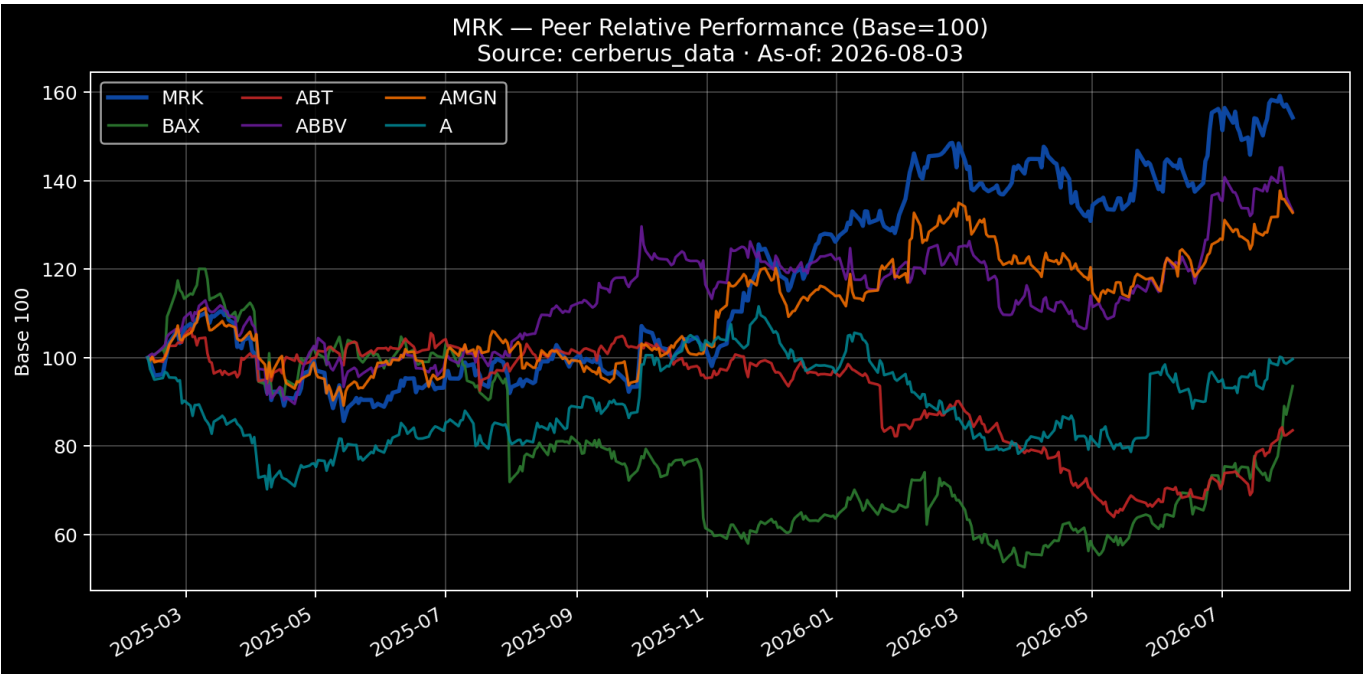


Figure 7. Peer Relative Performance (1Y, Base=100)
Read: relative performance sits near the 33th peer percentile. Why it matters: frames the allocation decision versus comparable alternatives. Source: peer snapshot / local market data · As-of: 2026-08-03

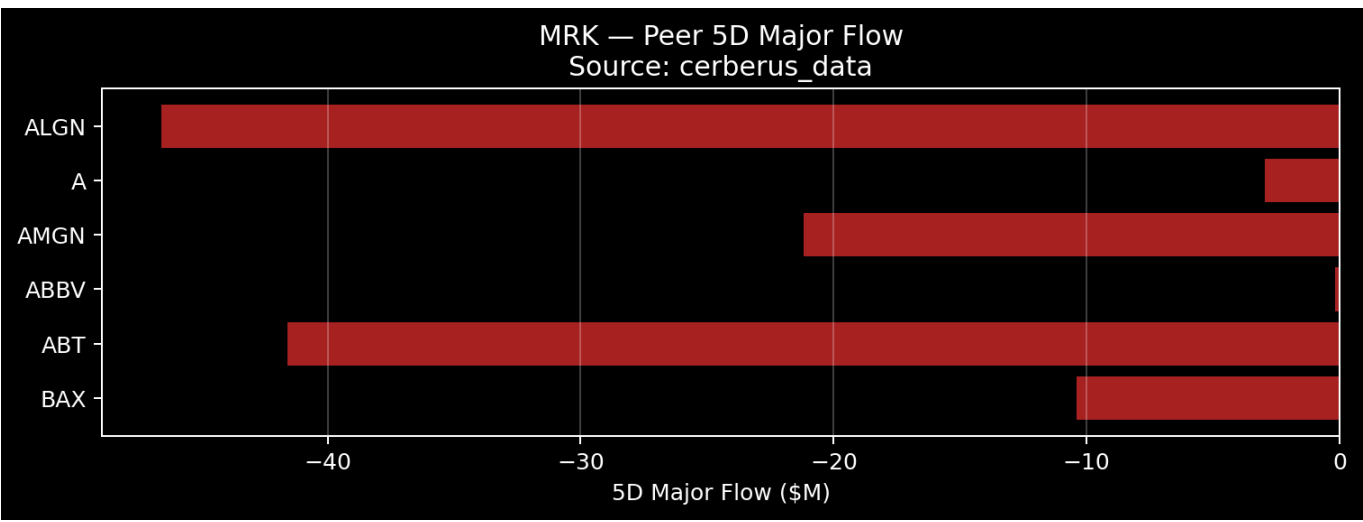


Figure 8. Peer 5D Major Flow
Why it matters: highlights where institutional flow is concentrating inside the peer set. Source: peer snapshot flows · As-of: 2026-07-31

Flow / Positioning Dashboard

AS OF 2026-07-31	MAJOR NET FLOW \$-10.08M
RETAIL NET FLOW \$-15.53M	MEDIUM NET FLOW \$-9.49M
SMALL NET FLOW \$-6.04M	5D MAJOR NET FLOW \$9.77M
5D RETAIL NET FLOW \$-117.37M	MAJOR INFLOW RATIO 0.03
MAJOR OUTFLOW RATIO 0.12	RETAIL INFLOW RATIO 0.36
RETAIL OUTFLOW RATIO 0.50	MAJOR DAILY Z-SCORE (20D) -0.64
SOURCE cerberus_data	FLOW TREND Institutional accumulation

Peer	5D Major Flow
ABBV	\$-194.89K
A	\$-2.96M
BAX	\$-10.39M

Flow Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	flows mixed
Implication	positioning is confirming the tape
Watch Next	watch for price/major-flow divergence to widen or close
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

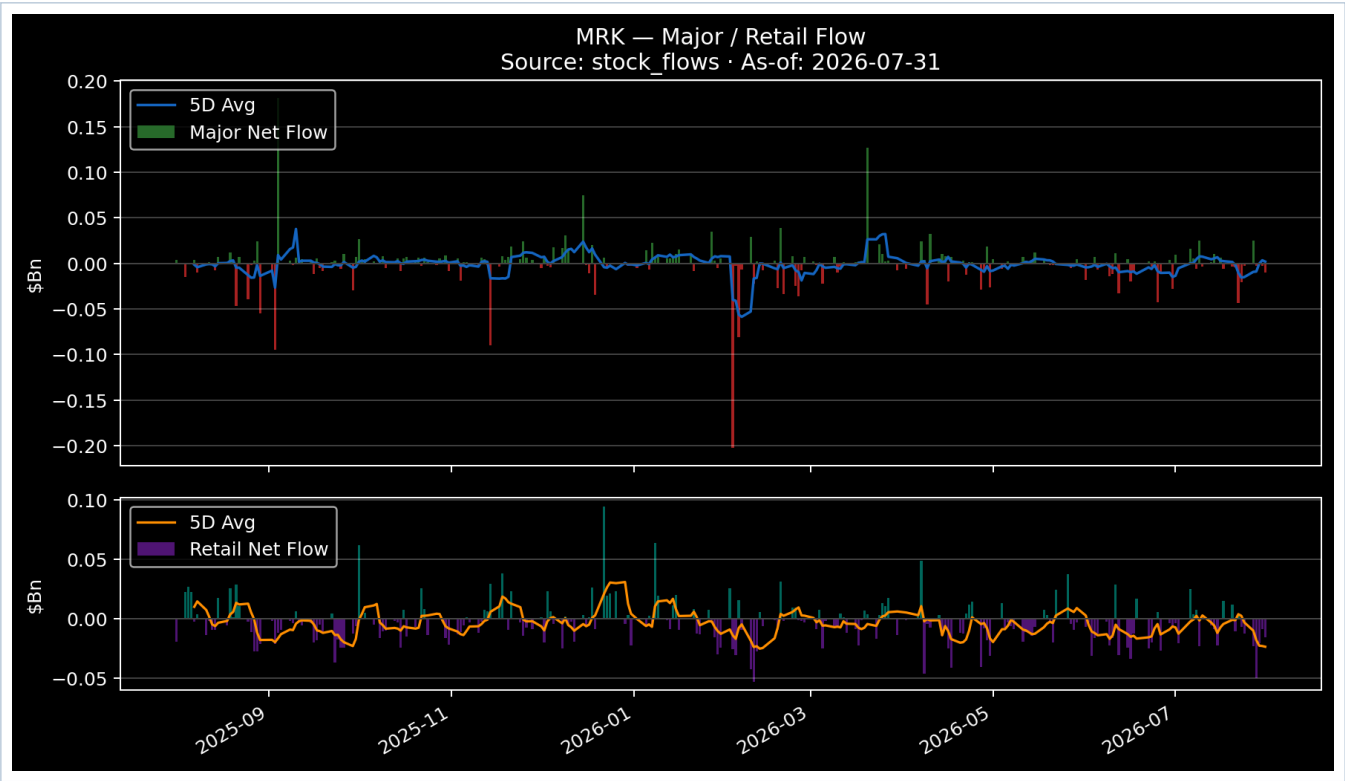


Figure 9. Major and Retail Flow Trend

Chart Read: Shows whether institutional and retail flows are confirming or fighting the tape.

Read: institutional flow supportive. Why it matters: shows whether positioning is confirming or fading the tape. Source: stock_flows · As-of: 2026-07-31

AAIL Retail Sentiment

AS OF 2026-07-23	BULLISH 29.59%
NEUTRAL 28.06%	BEARISH 42.35%
BULL-BEAR SPREAD -12.76	READ retail bearish

CBOE Volatility & Risk Premium

AS OF 2026-07-31	VIX9D 16.38
VIX 7.69	VIX3M 19.02
SKEW 141.23	TERM SLOPE (VIX3M - VIX9D) 2.64
BXM 2490.46	PUT INDEX 3557.59

Index	Value
LONGVOL	5.31
LOVOL	566.03
LTV	8.00
SHORTVOL	1766.07
SMILE	2526.34

Read: complacency

Macro / Liquidity / Positioning Dashboard

STATE neutral	OVERALL SCORE 0.19
AS OF 2026-07-31	

Component	Score
Liquidity	0.25
Volatility	-0.33
Breadth	1.00
Crowding	0.25
Rates	0.00
Macro Revision	0.00

Neutral tape; prioritize selectivity and benchmark-relative confirmation.

AS OF 2026-07-31	TAPE STATE Neutral
TOTAL PUT/CALL 0.91	EQUITY PUT/CALL 0.63
INDEX PUT/CALL 1.01	SKEW 141.23
VIX3M CLOSE 19.02	SPOTVOL CLOSE 7.69
VOL TERM PREMIUM 11.33	

forward vol above spot

AS OF 2026-07-31	NET LIQUIDITY \$5.83K
CREDIT SPREAD 0.80	HY SPREAD 2.84

YIELD CURVE 0.47	FINANCIAL STRESS -0.83
NFCI -0.55	10Y TERM PREMIUM 0.84
INTERPRETATION net liquidity positive	
NAAIM AS OF 2026-07-22	NAAIM EXPOSURE 84.02
NAAIM RANGE -25.00 / 200.00	NAAIM QUANTILES 85.00 / 95.50 / 100.00
NAAIM DISPERSION 43.61	DIX/GEX AS OF 2026-07-31
DIX 0.46	GEX \$5.74B
DIX Z-SCORE (20D) 0.82	GEX Z-SCORE (20D) 0.15
READ Crowded long; dark-pool accumulation	

Macro Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	macro backdrop mixed
Implication	macro should not be the only driver
Watch Next	watch regime state, liquidity stress, and sentiment crowding together
Confidence	high

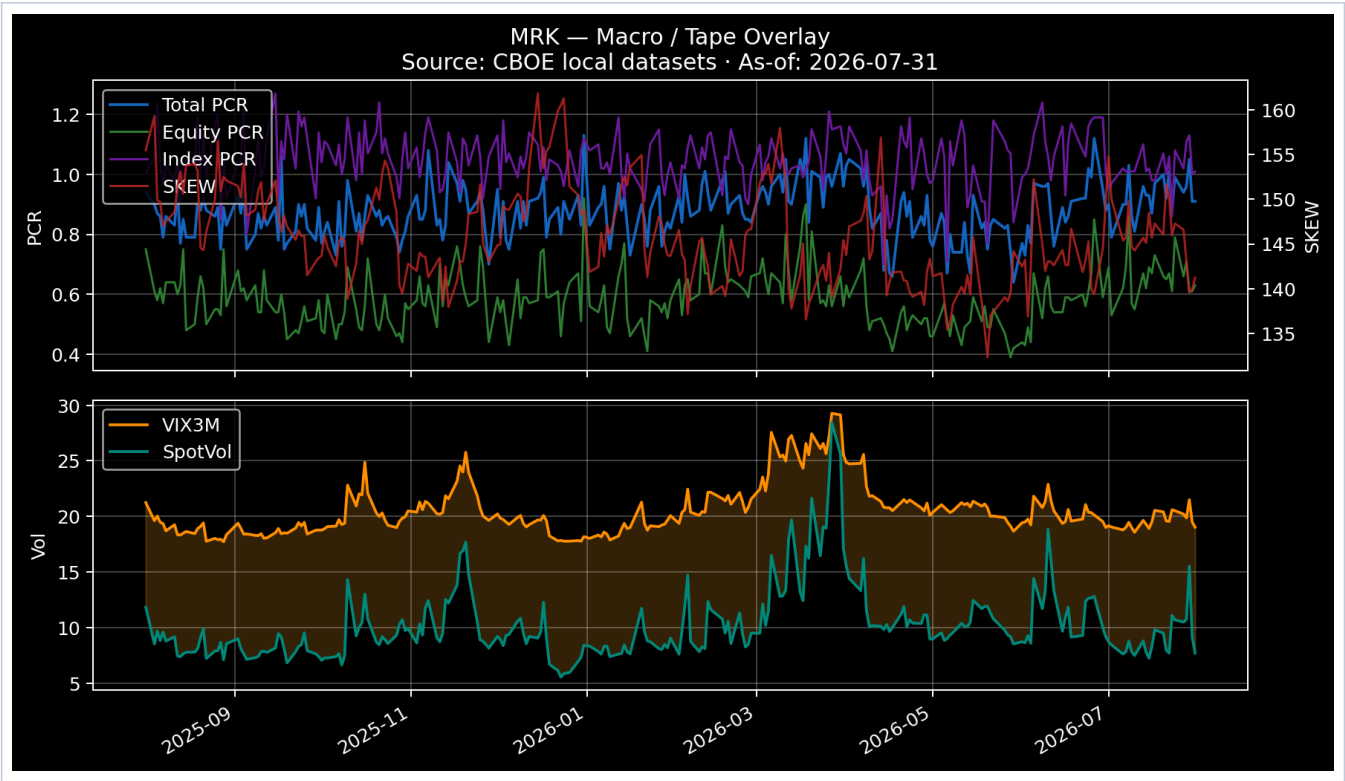


Figure 10. Macro and Tape Overlay

Why it matters: macro positioning can amplify or cap setup follow-through. Source: CBOE local datasets · As-of: 2026-07-31

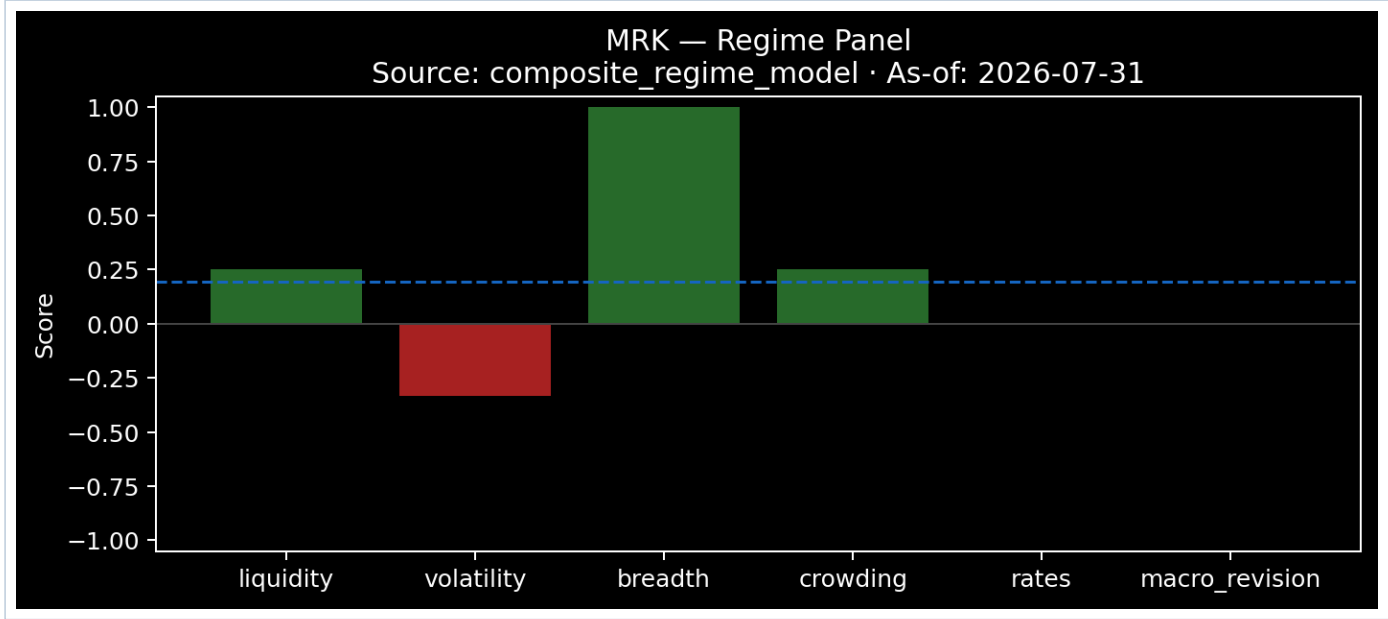


Figure 11. Market Regime Panel

Chart Read: Summarizes the macro regime drivers supporting or pressuring risk appetite.

Why it matters: regime alignment changes expected payoff and sizing discipline. Source: regime dataset · As-of: 2026-07-31

Technical Overview

SCORE 54.66/100	VERDICT MONITOR
---------------------------------------	---------------------------------------

REGIME Range	ADVICE Hold / Neutral
TREND Uptrend	CONFIDENCE 9.31%

Price vs Moving Averages

Period	Position	Level
SMA 20	Above SMA	\$127.37
SMA 50	Above SMA	\$123.15
SMA 200	Above SMA	\$111.80
VWAP	Above SMA	\$82.61
Supertrend(10,3)	Above SMA	\$123.14

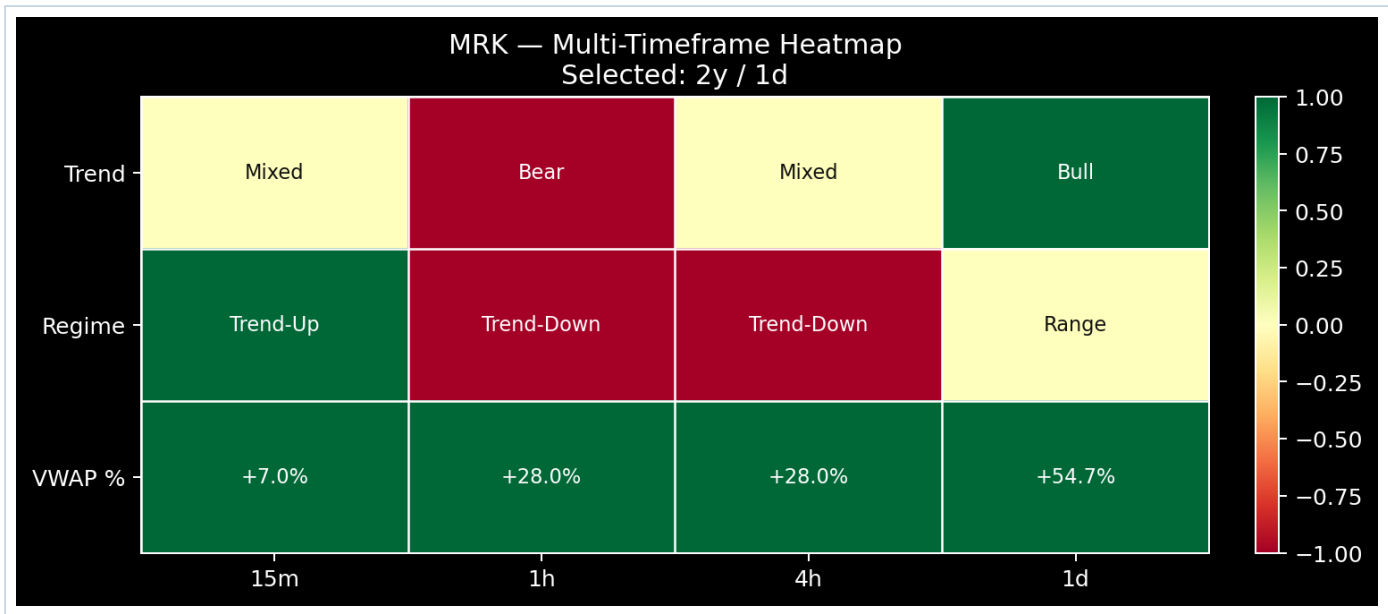


Figure 12. Multi-Timeframe Heatmap

Chart Read: Shows alignment or conflict across short and longer timeframes.

Why it matters: higher timeframe alignment improves follow-through odds. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

Technical Scorecard

Setup Classification	
PRIMARY SETUP Breakout	REASON trend 100, VCP 31, vol 50
TREND / REGIME Uptrend / Range	VERDICT / ADVICE MONITOR / Hold / Neutral
STRUCTURE STAGE Stage 2 / Markup	TREND STACK Mixed stack

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VALUE POSTURE
1/4 above

VCP / VOLATILITY STATE
30.7 / Expansion

Execution Card

TRIGGER
>135.05 or reclaim 129.17

INVALIDATION
<121.00 / EMA21 127.50

TARGET
141.31

REWARD / RISK
2.0:1

TIMEFRAME BIAS
Mixed

Watch Conditions

Trigger	Level / Status
Donchian Breakout	>135.05
VWAP Posture	+54.7%
EMA9 Reclaim/Hold	129.17
EMA21 Reclaim/Hold	127.50
Target	141.31
Volume Confirmation	49.8
Compression Flags	NR7 No / Inside No / TTM Off

Invalidation Logic

Check	Threshold
ATR Stop	<121.00
Donchian Lower	<120.16
Supertrend	<123.14
EMA21	<127.50
Current Drawdown	-3.9%
Risk / Reward	2.0:1

Timeframe Agreement

Interval	Trend	Regime	Price vs VWAP
15m	Mixed	Trend-Up	+7.0%
1h	Bear	Trend-Down	+28.0%
4h	Mixed	Trend-Down	+28.0%
1d	Bull	Range	+54.7%
Consensus	100.00%	Mixed	—

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Regime / Driver Breakdown

Driver	Value
Final Score	54.7
Confidence	9.3
Momentum	44.2
Trend	100.0
Risk Adjusted	78.6
Vol Stability	73.5
Drawdown	0.0
Volume Confirmation	49.8
ATR Percentile	94.8
Vol Clustering	-0.028
Gap Fill Prob	81.4%

Technical Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	technicals aligned
Implication	current structure supports acting on strength
Watch Next	breakout trigger, MTF bias Mixed, and volume confirmation
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

Market Structure Deep Dive

Support / Resistance Clusters

Side	Cluster
Resistance	128.00 (+0.2%) x4 [EMA9, Fib S1, Fib S2, S1]
Support	127.50 (-0.2%) x2 [EMA21, S2]

Distance Matrix

Level	Value	Distance
VWAP	82.61	+54.7%
EMA9	129.17	-1.1%
EMA21	127.50	+0.2%
SMA50	123.15	+3.7%
SMA200	111.80	+14.3%
Pivot	129.79	-1.6%

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Level	Value	Distance
R1	131.45	-2.8%
S1	128.55	-0.6%
Donchian Upper	135.05	-5.4%
Donchian Lower	120.16	+6.3%
Stop	121.00	+5.6%
Target	141.31	-9.6%

Candle / Bar Anatomy

O / H / L / C 129.87 / 131.47 / 126.72 / 127.77	BODY / UPPER WICK / LOWER WICK 44 / 34 / 22
RANGE / ATR 4.75 / 1.40x	CLOSING RANGE 22.1%
STREAK -1	

Historical Behavior Near Key MAs

MA	Behavior
DMA20	avg +0.2%
DMA50	avg +0.5%
DMA200	avg +0.6%

Compression / Expansion

Flag	Value
VCP Score	30.7
Volatility State	Expansion
TTM Squeeze	Off
NR7 / Inside Bar	No / No
ATR Percentile / Vol Clustering	94.8 / -0.028

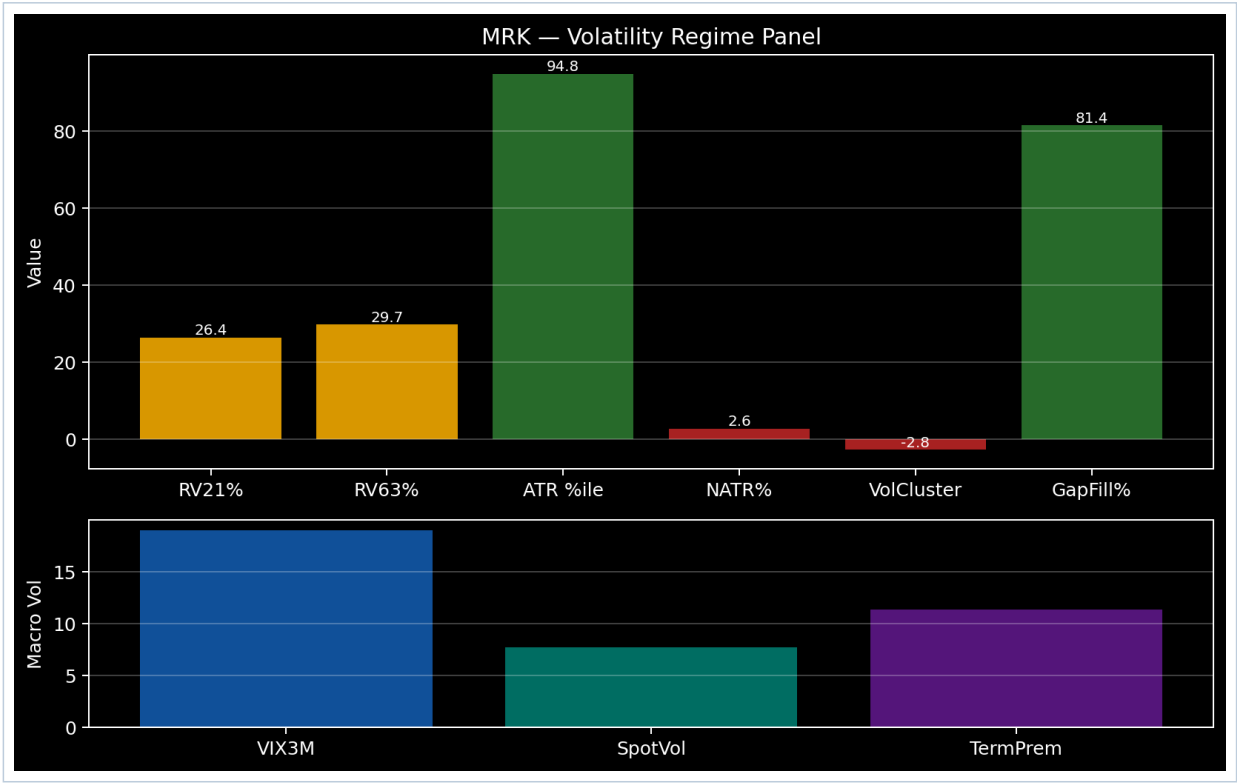


Figure 13. Volatility Regime Panel

Chart Read: Shows whether realized and implied volatility conditions favor expansion or compression.

Read: ATR is running near 2.6% of spot, so wider stops may be necessary. Why it matters: vol state affects breakout odds and stop placement. Source: technical indicators · As-of: 2026-08-03

Technical Indicators

Indicator	Value	Indicator	Value
RSI(14)	52.56	Stoch K/D	57.64/65.00
MACD	2.02	MACD Signal	2.15
MACD Hist	-0.14	Williams %R	-59.19
ADX(14)	19.44	CCI(20)	28.38
ATR(14)	3.38	NATR(14)%	2.65%
BB Upper	133.54	BB Lower	121.20
BB Position	53.25%	Z-Score	0.13
ROC(21)%	-1.38%	ROC(63)%	+13.92%
SAR	124.80	ER(10)	0.26
OBV Ratio	-0.00	52W Pos%	92.53%

Pattern Signals

Signal	Status
NR7	—

Signal	Status
Inside Bar	—
Bull Pin Bar	—
Bear Pin Bar	—
Closing Range%	22.11%
Streak (bars)	-1

Market Structure

WEINSTEIN STAGE Stage 2 (Uptrend)	VCP SCORE 30.75
---	---------------------------

Risk Levels (ATR-based)

Level	Price	Note
Stop Loss	\$121.00	2x ATR below entry
Target	\$141.31	4x ATR above entry
Risk/Reward	2.00:1	—

Risk & Quantitative Metrics

Metric	21D	63D
Realized Vol (Ann)	0.26%	0.30%
Sharpe Ratio	-0.50	1.90
Sortino Ratio	-0.89	3.93
Calmar	-2.11	8.10

CURRENT DRAWDOWN -3.90%	MAX DRAWDOWN (2Y) -44.74%
CVAR 95% -2.88%	KELLY FRACTION 0.15
HURST EXPONENT 1.00	SKEWNESS 0.10
KURTOSIS -0.72	VOL CLUSTERING -0.03
GAP FILL PROB% 81.43%	MONTHLY WIN RATE% 70.00%
MTF CONSENSUS% 100.00%	

Score Breakdown

Component	Score
Momentum	44.24
Trend	100.00
Mean Reversion	47.66
Bollinger	46.75
VWAP	0.00
Trend Strength	38.89
Vol Stability	73.51
Risk-Adjusted	78.57
Drawdown	0.00
Volume	49.81

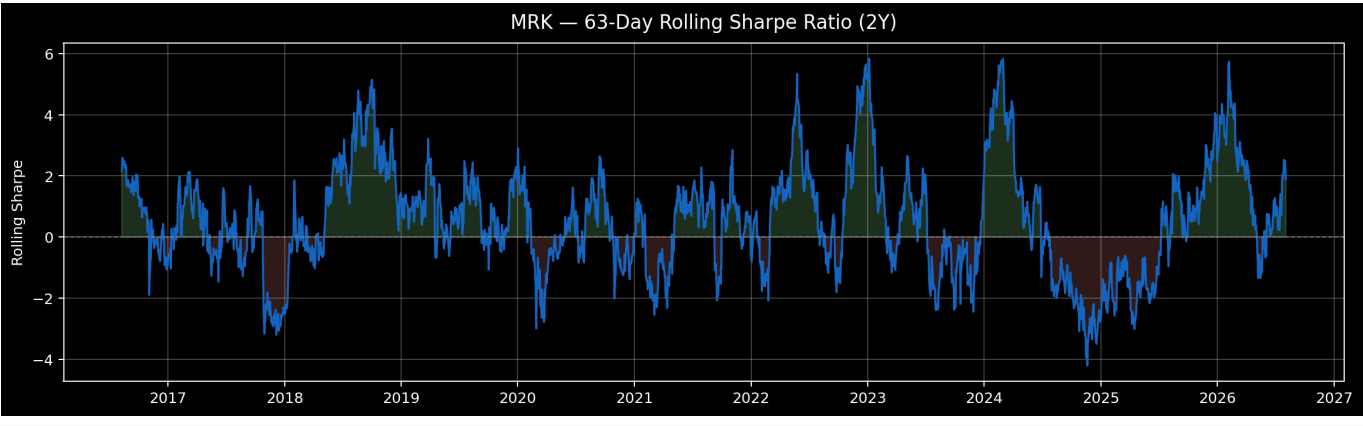


Figure 14. 63-Day Rolling Sharpe Ratio (2Y)

Chart Read: Shows whether returns have recently been efficient or unstable on a risk-adjusted basis.

Why it matters: shows whether recent returns have been efficient or unstable. Source: yfinance daily bars · As-of: 2026-08-03

NOTE
Primary sources: SEC companyfacts, local actions, yfinance fallback. Derived fields are labeled.

Issuer Profile

WEBSITE merck.com	INVESTOR RELATIONS IR
SEC PROFILE CIK	CIK 0000310158
LISTING NYSE / equity	COUNTRY United States
DOMICILE / LISTING United States / United States	EMPLOYEES 73.00K

IPO DATE
1962-01-02

STATUS REASON
active

ACTIVE LISTING
True

ETF / ADR / REIT
False / False / False

Identifiers

FIGI
BBG000BPD168

SHARE CLASS FIGI
BBG001S5TC52

OPENFIGI MARKET SECTOR
Equity

COMPOSITE FIGI
BBG000BPD168

OPENFIGI TYPE
Common Stock / Common Stock

OPENFIGI EXCHANGE / MIC
US

Valuation

TRAILING P/E
36.95

PEG RATIO
12.06

EV/EBITDA
12.16

MARKET CAP
\$318.48B

FORWARD P/E
13.37

P/S RATIO
4.84

PRICE/BOOK
6.94

ENTERPRISE VALUE
\$359.04B

Profitability & Margins

GROSS MARGIN
76.73%

NET MARGIN
13.59%

ROA
12.58%

R&D INTENSITY
24.01%

OP MARGIN
38.60%

ROE
18.94%

EBITDA
\$29.52B

GROSS PROFIT
\$50.46B

Income Statement (TTM)

REVENUE
\$65.77B

NET INCOME
\$8.94B

OPERATING INCOME
\$-3.20B

EBITDA
\$29.52B

Most Recent Quarter

Q REVENUE \$16.29B	Q OP INCOME \$-3.20B
Q NET INCOME \$-4.24B	Q OP CASH FLOW \$3.92B

Point-in-Time Trend Snapshot

Metric	2026-03-31	2025-12-31	2025-09-30	2025-06-30
Revenue	\$16.29B	\$16.40B	\$17.28B	\$15.81B
Net Income	\$-4.24B	\$2.96B	\$5.79B	\$4.43B
Operating Income	\$-3.20B	\$4.07B	\$6.55B	\$5.55B
Operating Cash Flow	\$3.92B	\$2.86B	\$7.82B	\$3.29B

Fundamental Score Summary

GROWTH SCORE 50.00	QUALITY SCORE 71.79
RESILIENCE SCORE 55.86	CAPITAL ALLOCATION SCORE 52.61
OVERALL FUNDAMENTAL SCORE 57.57	OVERALL POSTURE Balanced

Margin Trend / Growth Regime

GROWTH REGIME Stable compounder	REVENUE TREND insufficient history
GROSS MARGIN TREND insufficient history	OPERATING MARGIN TREND insufficient history
NET MARGIN TREND insufficient history	

Balance Sheet & Resilience

TOTAL ASSETS \$136.87B	TOTAL LIABILITIES \$84.20B
STOCKHOLDERS EQUITY \$52.61B	CASH & EQUIVALENTS \$14.56B
TOTAL DEBT \$49.12B	NET DEBT \$34.55B
STRESS READ Liquidity pressure	NET DEBT / EBITDA 1.17
CURRENT / QUICK RATIO 1.30 / 0.70	DEBT / EQUITY 106.94

Cash Flow & Conversion

OPERATING CASH FLOW
\$17.89B

FREE CASH FLOW
\$14.05B

FCF / NET INCOME
1.57

EARNINGS QUALITY
Cash-backed earnings

CAPITAL EXPENDITURES (DERIVED)
\$3.84B

OCF / NET INCOME
2.00

CAPEX INTENSITY (DERIVED)
5.84%

Ownership & Short Interest

INSIDER HOLDING
0.06%

SHORT % FLOAT
1.19%

SHARES SHORT
29.36M

INST. HOLDING
82.13%

SHORT RATIO (DTC)
2.59

Growth & Yield

REVENUE GROWTH
4.90%

FCF YIELD
4.41%

EPS FWD
9.65

PAYOUT RATIO
93.52%

Capital Returns & Share Count

DIVIDEND YIELD
2.61%

DIVIDEND CADENCE
quarterly

SHARES OUTSTANDING
2.47B

SHAREHOLDER YIELD (EST.)
2.61%

BUYBACK / DILUTION REGIME
Stable

PAYOUT RATIO
93.52%

LATEST DIVIDEND
2026-06-15

SHARE COUNT TREND
insufficient history

YIELD DECOMPOSITION
dividend 2.61% + buyback -%

Valuation Context

TRAILING P/E CONTEXT
rich

FORWARD P/E CONTEXT
cheap

EV / EBITDA CONTEXT
fair

OVERALL VALUATION POSTURE
Value-leaning

FCF YIELD CONTEXT
attractive

COVERAGE NOTE
peer/sector valuation history unavailable in current snapshot

Sector-Relative Fundamentals

NET MARGIN PERCENTILE
not meaningful

FUNDAMENTAL MOMENTUM SCORE
57.57

OPERATING MARGIN PERCENTILE
not meaningful

RELATIVE READ
insufficient peer sample

Fundamentals Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	balanced
Implication	fundamentals are serviceable but not dominant
Watch Next	watch growth regime, cash conversion, and share-count drift together
Confidence	medium

Valuation Sanity Flags

TRAILING PE
36.95

EV / EBITDA
12.16

DIVIDEND YIELD
2.61%

FORWARD PE
13.37

PRICE / SALES
4.84

FLAG COUNT
2

Flag	Read
Valuation	trailing PE screens rich at 36.95
Valuation	forward PE screens cheap at 13.37

Fundamental Quality Panel

QUALITY SCORE
79.89

GROWTH
revenue 4.90%

FCF YIELD
4.41%

DEBT / EQUITY
106.94

VERDICT
Strong

MARGINS
gross 76.73%, operating 38.60%, net 13.59%

LIQUIDITY
current 1.30, quick 0.70

Fundamental Quality Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	fundamental quality strong
Implication	fundamentals support paying up for the name
Watch Next	watch growth, FCF yield, and leverage move in the same direction
Confidence	high

Curated Fundamentals

NOTE No curated fundamentals available.

Corporate Actions

NOTE Charts and relative returns use adjusted close when available; raw OHLC remains unadjusted.
--

Recent Dividends

Date	Amount	Source
2026-06-15	0.85	yfinance
2026-03-16	0.85	yfinance
2025-12-15	0.85	yfinance
2025-09-15	0.81	yfinance

Earnings & Revenue

Next Earnings

Next Date	EPS Estim...	Revenue Estimate
2026-08-04	-0.26	\$16.37B

Estimate Range

Metric	Low	High
EPS Estimate	-0.40	-0.06
Revenue Estimate	\$16.23B	\$16.70B

EPS Surprise History (Last 8 Quarters)

Date	EPS Estim...	Reported E...	Surprise
2026-04-30	-1.47	-1.28	OK 13.15%
2026-02-03	2.01	2.04	OK 1.47%

Research only. Not investment advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Date	EPS Estim...	Reported E...	Surprise
2025-10-30	2.35	2.58	OK 9.85%
2025-07-29	2.03	2.13	OK 5.04%
2025-04-24	2.14	2.22	OK 3.98%
2025-02-04	1.67	1.72	OK 3.30%
2024-10-31	1.57	1.57	OK 0.03%
2024-07-30	2.14	2.28	OK 6.31%

Annual Revenue & Net Income

Year	Revenue	Net Income	Net Margin
2025	\$65.01B	\$18.25B	28.08%
2024	\$64.17B	\$17.12B	26.68%
2023	\$60.12B	\$365.00M	0.61%
2022	\$59.28B	\$14.52B	24.49%
2021	—	—	—

Share Buybacks (Annual)

Year	Repurchases
2025	\$5.08B
2024	\$1.31B
2023	\$1.35B
2022	\$0.00

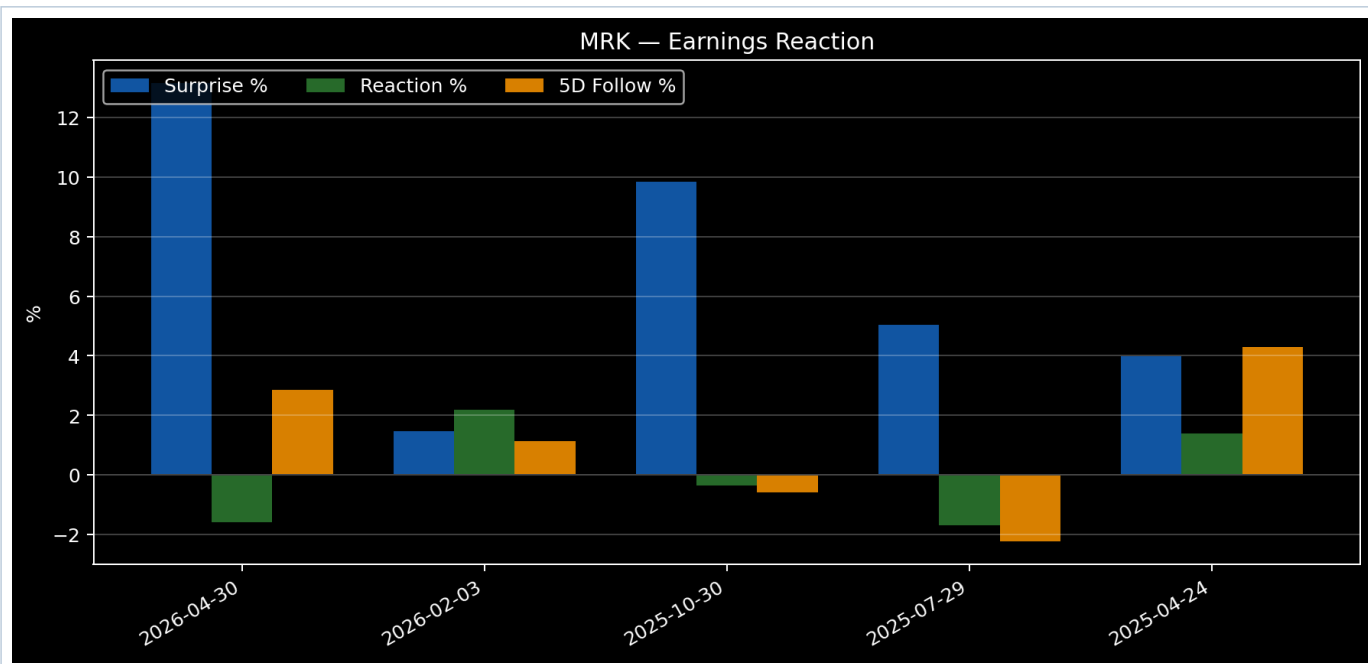


Figure 15. Earnings Reaction

Chart Read: Shows how the stock has typically moved around earnings events.

Why it matters: event reaction history sets expectations into the next print. Source: earnings history · As-of: 2024-07-30

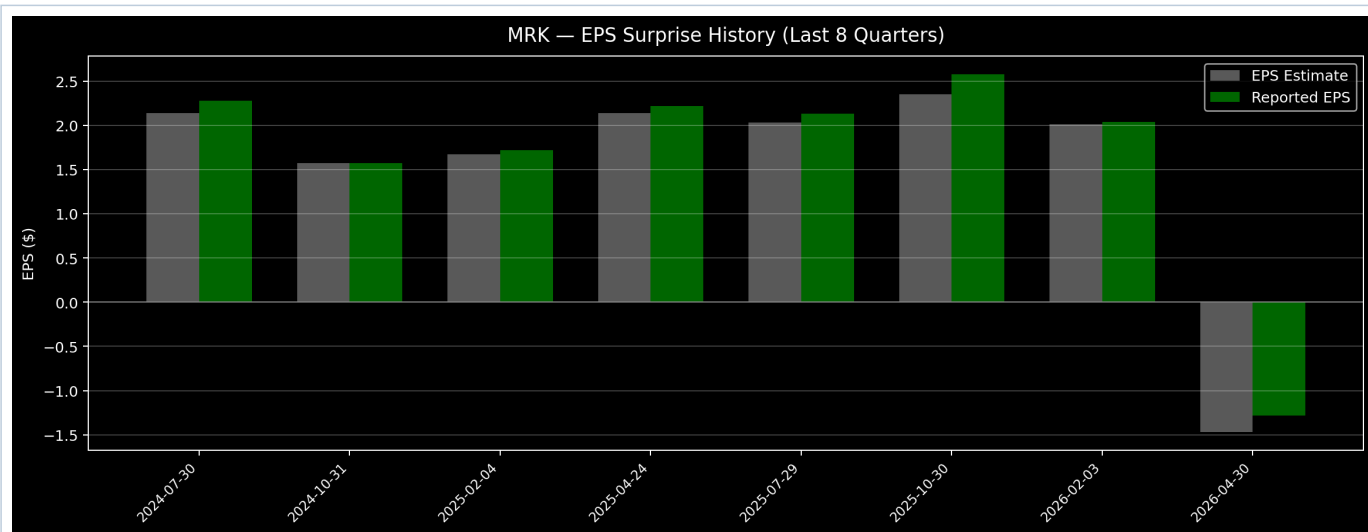


Figure 16. EPS Surprise History

Chart Read: Shows whether earnings have tended to beat or miss expectations.

Why it matters: surprise consistency helps separate narrative from execution. Source: earnings history · As-of: 2024-07-30

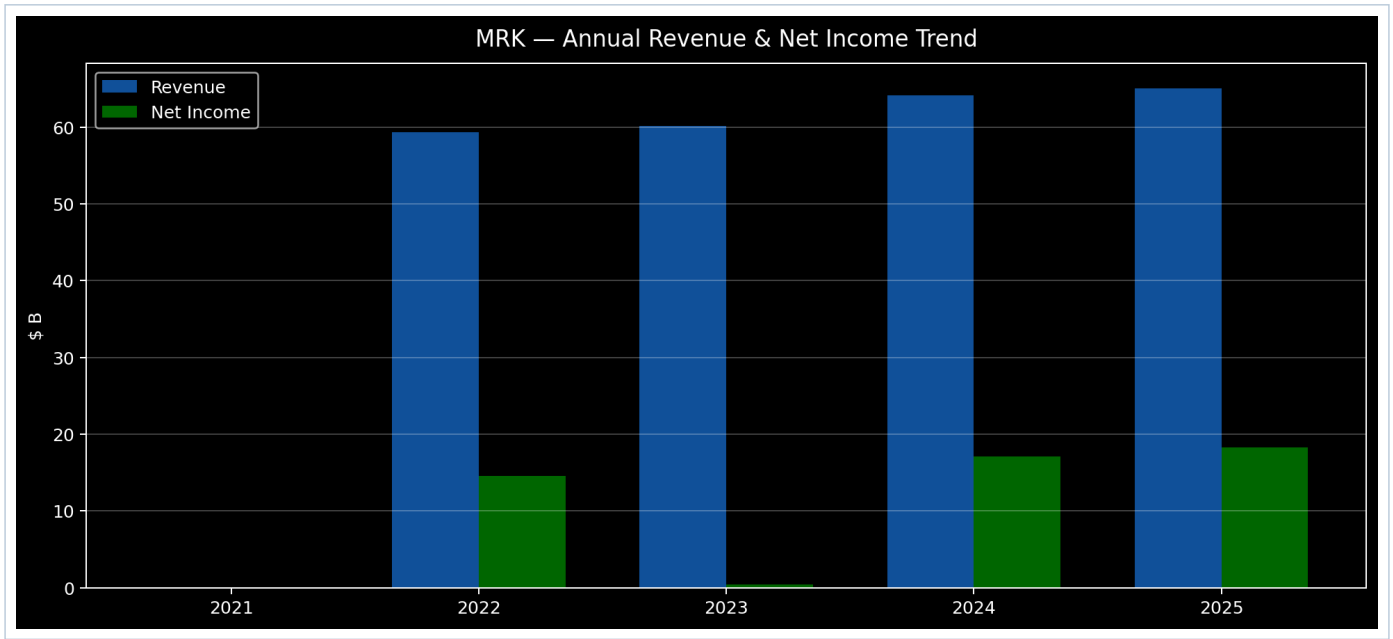


Figure 17. Annual Revenue & Net Income Trend

Chart Read: Shows the slope and consistency of top-line growth and profitability.

Why it matters: slope and consistency matter more than one quarter in isolation. Source: annual revenue history · As-of: 1970-01-01

Options Snapshot

NEAREST EXPIRY 2026-08-07	ATM IV (CALLS) 38.57%
ATM IV (PUTS) 33.44%	PUT/CALL RATIO 0.72
TOTAL CALL OI 6.88K	TOTAL PUT OI 6.62K

Options Expected Move

FRONT EXPIRY 2026-08-07	DTE 3
ATM IV USED 38.57%	EXPECTED MOVE +/-5.38 (4.21%)
IMPLIED RANGE 122.39 to 133.15	

Analyst Consensus

RECOMMENDATION BUY	ANALYST COUNT 26
TARGET (MEAN) \$135.38	TARGET RANGE \$105.00 - \$155.00

Rating	Count	Share
Strong Buy	4	# 13.79%
Buy	15	##### 51.72%
Hold	9	### 31.03%
Sell	0	0.00%
Strong Sell	1	3.45%

Recent Upgrades / Downgrades

Date	Firm	Action	Grade
2026-07-09	Morgan Stanley	Reiterate	Equal-Weight
2026-07-08	RBC Capital	Reiterate	Outperform
2026-07-08	Wells Fargo	Reiterate	Overweight
2026-07-06	Cantor Fitzgerald	Reiterate	Neutral
2026-06-30	B of A Securities	Reiterate	Buy
2026-06-30	Scotiabank	Reiterate	Sector Outperform
2026-06-24	CICC	Initiate	Outperform
2026-05-01	Wells Fargo	Reiterate	Overweight

Analyst Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	street view constructive
Implication	consensus can support upside if execution stays intact
Watch Next	watch target dispersion and rating breadth for revision pressure
Confidence	medium / conflicting signals

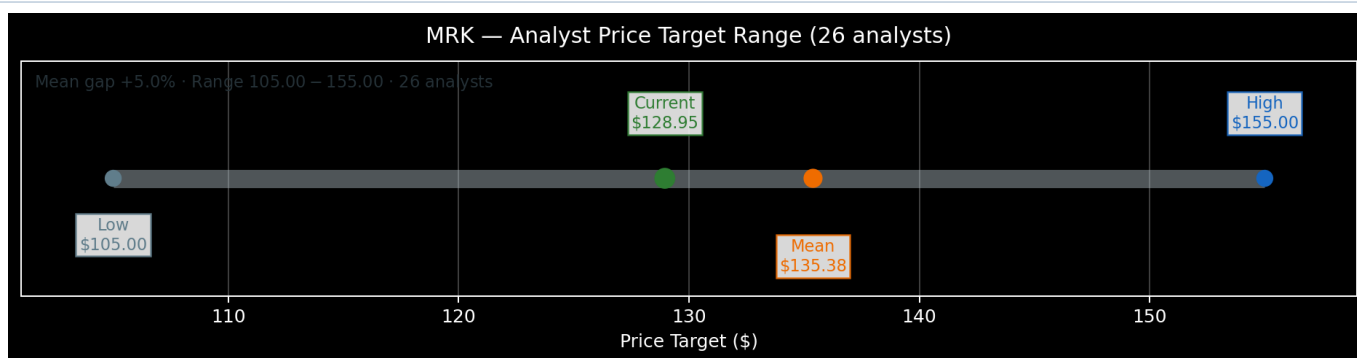


Figure 18. Analyst Price Target Range

Chart Read: Shows how optimistic or conservative the street target range currently is.

Read: consensus implies +6.0% with 36.9% target spread. Why it matters: shows how much of the upside case is already in consensus. Source: analyst consensus · As-of: 2026-08-03

Ownership / Crowding Context

CROWDING READ Distribution risk	TOP INSTITUTIONAL HOLDER Blackrock Inc.
TOP INSTITUTIONAL VALUE \$27.90B	TOP-5 INSTITUTIONAL CONCENTRATION 25.51%
INSTITUTIONAL HOLDER COUNT 5	TOP MUTUAL FUND HOLDER VANGUARD INDEX FUNDS-Vanguard Total Stock Market Index Fund
TOP-5 MUTUAL FUND CONCENTRATION 9.15%	MUTUAL FUND % OUT (TOP-5) 9.55%
RECENT INSIDER BUYS / SELLS 0 / 4	RECENT INSIDER NET VALUE \$-18.09M

Ownership Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	distribution risk
Implication	holder base can amplify downside if conviction breaks
Watch Next	watch insider net activity against concentration changes
Confidence	high

Ownership Change Over Time

STATUS Unavailable	REASON Need at least two major-holder history snapshots to compute...
------------------------------	---

SEC Insider Transactions

AS OF 2026-06-30	BUY / SELL COUNT 15 / 0
NET SHARES 22,660.35	NET VALUE \$2.69M

Date	Insider Name	Label	Direction	Shares	Price	Owned After
2026-06-30	Seidman Christine E	Grant Or Award	buy	63.23	128.50	21,291.27
2026-06-30	Karsanbhai Surendralal Lanca	Grant Or Award	buy	126.46	128.50	5,518.80
2026-06-30	Coe Mary Ellen	Grant Or Award	buy	233.46	128.50	31,999.10
2026-05-29	Warden Kathy J	Grant Or Award	buy	1,853.10	118.72	17,890.29
2026-05-29	Karsanbhai Surendralal Lanca	Grant Or Award	buy	1,853.10	118.72	5,392.34

Top Institutional Holders

Holder	Shares	Value	% Held	As Of
Blackrock Inc.	225.83M	\$27.90B	9.14%	2026-03-31
Vanguard Capital Management LLC	160.99M	\$19.89B	6.52%	2026-03-31
State Street Corporation	119.33M	\$14.74B	4.83%	2026-03-31
Wellington Management Group, LLP	84.31M	\$10.42B	3.41%	2026-03-31
Vanguard Portfolio Management LLC	67.30M	\$8.31B	2.73%	2026-03-31

Mutual Fund Holders

Holder	Shares	% Out	Value	As Of
VANGUARD INDEX FUNDS-Vanguard Total Stock Market Index Fund	78.52M	3.18%	\$9.70B	2026-03-31
VANGUARD INDEX FUNDS-Vanguard 500 Index Fund	63.07M	2.55%	\$7.79B	2026-03-31
iShares Trust-iShares Core S&P 500 ETF	32.70M	1.32%	\$4.04B	2026-05-31
Fidelity Concord Street Trust-Fidelity 500 Index Fund	31.76M	1.29%	\$3.92B	2026-05-31
SPDR S&P 500 ETF TRUST-State Street SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	29.92M	1.21%	\$3.70B	2026-05-31

Insider Activity (yfinance)

Filing Date	Insider Name	Title	Trade Type	Price	Qty	Value
2026-05-01	SMART DALTON E. III	Officer	N/A Exercise	112.16	383	42957.00
2026-05-01	MARALDO DAVID R.	Officer	N/A Exercise	112.16	552	61912.00
2026-04-30	SMART DALTON E. III	Officer	N/A Exercise	110.49	1408	155349.00
2026-04-29	GUINDO CHIRFI	Officer	N/A Exercise	110.03	1967	216429.00
2026-02-12	GUINDO CHIRFI	Officer	DOWN S	121.46	10000	1214562.00
2026-02-10	LI DEAN Y	Officer	DOWN S	117.52	10235	1202844.00
2026-02-09	GUINDO CHIRFI	Officer	DOWN S	118.41	10000	1184101.00
2026-02-09	ZACHARY JENNIFER L	General Counsel	DOWN S	119.15	121573	14485690.00

Insider Pressure Summary

BUY COUNT 0	SELL COUNT 4
NET VALUE \$-18.09M	NET VALUE / MARKET CAP -0.01%

Recent News

NOTE

Narrative: bullish bias in recent headlines; active downside headline risk.

Coverage: 5 relevant headlines reviewed; 5 dated items.

Lens	Headlines
Bullish	Merck, Pfizer Lift Full-Year Sales Outlooks Following Second-Quarter Beats
Bearish	Merck Stock Rises as Wall Street Looks Past Earnings Guidance Cut to Oncology Strength
Neutral	Merck posts better-than-expected second-quarter results on Keytruda strength ; Compared to Estimates, Merck (MRK) Q2 Earnings: A Look at Key Metrics ; The Merck Product That Absolutely Demolished Wall Street's Forecasts

Date	Publisher	Tag	Impact	Headline
2026-08-04	Reuters	legal	[LOW] [RECENT]	Merck posts better-than-expected second-quarter results on Keytruda strength
2026-08-04	MT Newswires	legal	[LOW] [RECENT]	Merck, Pfizer Lift Full-Year Sales Outlooks Following Second-Quarter Beats
2026-08-04	Barrons.com	earnings	[HIGH] [RECENT]	Merck Stock Rises as Wall Street Looks Past Earnings Guidance Cut to Oncology Strength
2026-08-04	Zacks	earnings	[HIGH] [RECENT]	Compared to Estimates, Merck (MRK) Q2 Earnings: A Look at Key Metrics
2026-08-04	Investor's Business Daily	general	[LOW] [RECENT]	The Merck Product That Absolutely Demolished Wall Street's Forecasts

Short Sale Pressure

AS OF 2026-07-31	SHORT VOLUME 954644.00
SHORT EXEMPT VOLUME 7263.00	TOTAL VOLUME 2123755.00
SHORT VOLUME RATIO 44.95%	SHORT EXEMPT VOLUME RATIO 0.34%
5D AVG SHORT VOLUME RATIO 44.32%	20D AVG SHORT VOLUME RATIO 50.30%
READ Short pressure easing	

Short Interest Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	short pressure easing
Implication	squeeze risk is easing
Watch Next	watch short ratio versus 20D average and price response together
Confidence	high

Event Risk Calendar

Event	Date	Distance	Note
Earnings	2026-08-04	Today	scheduled
Dividend	2026-06-15	50d ago	last cash event
8-K	2026-05-28	68d ago	latest filing

Catalyst / Event Risk

Driver	Status
Next Earnings	2026-08-04
Latest Dividend	2026-06-15
Analyst Target Gap	5.96%

SEC Filing Timeline

LATEST FORM 8-K	LATEST FILING DATE 2026-05-28
LATEST REPORT DATE 2026-05-26	LATEST FILING LAG 2.00d

8-K COUNT (90D)

3

10-Q COUNT (365D)

2

10-K COUNT (365D)

1

Form	Filing Date	Report D...	Lag	Type
8-K	2026-05-28	2026-05-26	2.00d	8-K
8-K	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	0.00d	8-K
10-Q	2026-05-04	2026-03-31	34.00d	10-Q
8-K	2026-04-30	2026-04-30	0.00d	8-K
10-K	2026-02-24	2025-12-31	55.00d	10-K

End Summary

Lens	Close
Profile	full
Action Bias	Hold / Neutral
Score / Verdict	54.66 / MONITOR
Risk Box	stop 121.00 / trade target 141.31
Analyst Mean Gap	5.96%
Flow Context	\$9.77M
Regime / Catalyst	neutral / 2026-08-04

Closing Insight

Lens	Insight
Read	setup remains actionable into the next catalyst window
Implication	size to the setup only if flow, relative strength, and event path stay aligned
Watch Next	watch stop discipline, benchmark-relative tape, and catalyst timing together
Confidence	medium / stale inputs

Appendix

NOTE

Reference material, data provenance, and lower-priority diagnostics.

DATASET ROOT

cerberus_data

FRESH / STALE / UNKNOWN

0 / 25 / 1

TRACKED DATASETS

26

Dataset	As Of	Age	SLA	Status	Source
SEC Events	2026-05-28	1649.1h	no SLA	stale	sec_submissions
Actions	2026-06-15	1197.2h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
SEC Insider	2026-06-30	857.1h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
NAAIM	2026-07-22	329.1h	no SLA	stale	cerberus_data
aaii_sentiment	2026-07-23	305.1h	no SLA	stale	aaii_sentiment
cboe_bxm	2026-07-31	113.1h	no SLA	stale	cboe_bxm
cboe_longvol	2026-07-31	113.1h	no SLA	stale	cboe_longvol
cboe_lovol	2026-07-31	113.1h	no SLA	stale	cboe_lovol

+18 additional datasets tracked in companion manifest.

Methodology

NOTE

Definitions

Topic	Note
Score Components	Momentum, Trend, Mean Reversion, Bollinger, VWAP, Trend Strength, Vol Stability, Risk Adjusted, Drawdown, Volume Confirmation
Flow Divergence Logic	Flow divergence compares 5D/20D price returns against cumulative major and retail net flow from local stock_flows; positive major flow with flat/down price flags accumulation, negative major flow with resilient price flags distribution.
Benchmark Selection	Benchmarks prefer index membership and sector mapping from local security/index snapshots; current order SPY.

Fallback Usage

Dataset	Handling	Severity
fundamentals	fundamentals dataset unavailable	optional
options_summary	options_summary dataset unavailable	optional
sec_company_tickers	sec_company_tickers dataset unavailable	optional

NOTE

Report generated by SanCapital Cerberus — for research purposes only.

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- Figure 6: Breadth and Leadership Context
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Document Control

Report Schema	2
Classification	INTERNAL
Generated	report_MRK_20260804_170820_771657
Git Commit	e97f0b7